

Who was it that said "And never the twain shall meet"?



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Dhawal Damle from Delhi. He wins

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A Mini Keypad by Travel Pac just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should be shot by you, and should not have been published earlier. Send your picture to digipick@thinkdigit.com. The prize-winning picture will be published each month.



Cell use while driving is on the rise

2002 and a 100 per cent rise in four years. Drivers aged between 16 and 24 increased their talking on cell phones by 60 per cent between 2002 and 2004.

"While we don't have hard evidence that there's been an increase in the number of crashes, we know that talking on the phone can degrade driver performance," NHTSA spokesman Rae Tyson said.

Washington DC and the State of New Hampshire no longer allow talking on hand-held cell phones while driving. Some communities require hands-free cell phones.

The National Transportation Safety Board said it wants all the 50 states of the US to ban those with learner's permits from using cell phones, or other wireless devices while

driving. So far, however, only two such states have passed such a law.

MICROSOFT TECHFEST

Baby-sitting Bots!

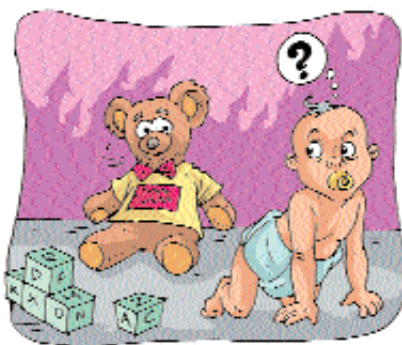
Think about a teddy bear sitting in the corner of a child's room, his head following the kid around using a face recognition program, also allowing a parent talk to the child through a special phone—or monitor the child via a camera and wireless Internet connection. The prototype, on display at Microsoft's annual gadget showcase, is one of several ideas researchers have for

robots. The idea is to create a virtual being that can visit the neighbouring cubicle for a live telephone chat while the owner is travelling thousands of miles away, for example.

The 'Teddy' project was one of about 150 projects on display at Microsoft's TechFest, a two-day event that gives Microsoft's worldwide team of researchers the chance to show product developers their creations. TechFest opened on March 2, mainly to full-time Microsoft employees. The company expected about 6,000 to attend, including Chairman Bill Gates and other executives.

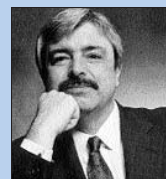
Another idea at TechFest came from Raman Sarin, a Microsoft development engineer. Sarin's invention is SmartPhlow, a program that not only monitors current traffic patterns but also uses real-time and archived data to predict when the next traffic jam might occur.

SmartPhlow, which can work on



Modem Man

We take the humble modem for granted, but the fact is that the Internet could not have become what it is without the invention of the PC modem. It was Dennis Hayes who set the stage for massive computer-to-computer communication by inventing the PC modem in 1977. This established the



Dennis Hayes

technology that would allow the then online and Internet industries to emerge and grow.

Hayes had been working at a computer services firm that used leased-line modems for point-to-point connectivity between microcomputers. He wanted to open those lines of communication so any one system could talk to another, and created the standard AT command set, a software string that let any computer with a serial port activate features on an intelligent modem.

In January 1978, he founded D C Hayes & Associates, Inc, the company known today as Hayes Corp. Innovations at Hayes' company resulted in performance enhancements and cost reductions that led the industry in the conversion from leased-line modems to the intelligent-dial modem, or PC modem. The PC modem was initially sold to hobbyists. Soon, D C Hayes & Associates became a 1,500-employee company, operating in 44 countries.

Hayes' eyesight began deteriorating in the '70s, and he today champions Net accessibility for the visually and hearing impaired.